AI, HONESTLY · EIGHT ESSAYS, ONE THREAD

# AI made making cheap.

## What it didn’t make cheap is now the work.

Remember Store Trust Specify Check Carry Notice Care

# The shift

### Cheap now

~~Writing code~~

~~Drafting text~~

~~Generating answers~~

~~Producing features~~

### Still expensive

**Remembering what we learned**

**Trusting an answer**

**Checking what matters**

**Carrying what we made**

**Knowing why it matters**

Eight essays, written over one month. Each one looks at a different piece of what stays expensive.

01 · REMEMBER

# Learn slowly, once. Act fast, every time.

Most agents reason from scratch on every run, so they repeat their mistakes and forget what they learned. Use the large model once, to build a memory people can inspect. Let small, explainable models run the routine. Keep the agent for the exceptions.

Essay · **Fast AI**

02 · STORE

# Keep in the weights what you use on every word. Look up the rest.

**19,000**

tokens: the point where a small model’s working memory outweighs the model itself (1B parameters, 4-bit weights)

Weights are dense but hard to change. A table changes one row at a time.

Essay · **Where Memory Lives**

03 · TRUST

# Agreement is a cheap alarm. But coherent is not true.

**99.8%**

right when ten networks all agreed. When they all learned the same shortcut, agreement did no better than chance.

Disagreement tells you when to look it up. Only the world tells you when everyone is wrong together.

Essay · **Coherence Is Measurable**

04 · SPECIFY

# Intent is the new source code.

What we write moves up a level: intent plus the checks that prove it. Code becomes an output, still readable, rarely written. The new language is exactly as precise as its tests.

Essay · **Intent Is the Source**

05 · CHECK

# Approve what you cannot undo. Watch everything else.

Reviewing every change made sense when fixes were slow and code was typed by hand. Now: rules for every session, merge on green, a daily audit of the whole codebase, and a person at the point of no return.

Essay · **Stop Reviewing Pull Requests**

06 · CARRY

# Everything you make, you carry.

AI lowers the cost of making, not of carrying. Every feature, test and document needs attention for as long as it lives. A process is mass too: in a heavier world, frameworks like Scrum and SAFe must get lighter, not heavier.

Essay · **Work Has Mass**

07 · NOTICE

# Show what changed in our understanding, not the data.

Most weeks, a good dashboard is empty. But a quiet screen must earn its silence: say what it checked, what it could not explain, and when it last proved it can still see.

Essay · **Show What Changed, Not the Data**

08 · CARE

# What stays ours is choosing the question, and caring about it.

A machine has no reason of its own to want an answer. We do. Students who practised with a plain chatbot scored 17% lower once it was taken away: keep the effort that builds the skill, and the joy.

Essay · **The Joy of the Question**

# The thread

## When making is cheap, the value moves to everything around it.

01
Remember what you learned

02
Store it where it’s cheap to use

03
Trust, but check against the world

04
Specify the intent, not the code

05
Check only what you can’t undo

06
Carry less

07
Notice what changed

08
Care why it matters

# Which step is the hardest where you work?

All essays, with code and data, in English and French

**scuenat.github.io**

**Tell me in the comments. Good questions often become the next essay.**